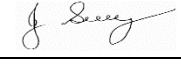


SAFE WORK METHOD STATEMENT

Persons responsible for supervising, inspecting work, work methods, plant & equipment and tools	Supervisor/Foreman: Neville Young	Date:	12/05/2026
High Risk Construction Work:	EXCAVATOR & ATTACHMENTS - SAFE OPERATION	Project:	
SWMS prepared by Patrick Monaghan - Paneltec Group - Operations Manager and in consultation with management and workers – 2025. SWMS Review Date: August 2026 unless required earlier		Location:	Dry St, Invermay
Approval to use this SWMS: "I certify that the attached SWMS has been reviewed by me, is endorsed for compliance with WorkSafe guidelines and is approved for use"			
John Guy Name	Director - Paneltec Pty Ltd Position	0408 449 023 Phone	 Signature
			31/08/2025 – V12.0 Date

RISK MATRIX

Level	Description of Consequence or Impact	Consequence	Likelihood / Probability		
			L <i>Likely</i>	M <i>Moderate</i>	U <i>Unlikely</i>
H (1) <i>(High level of harm)</i>	Potential death, permanent disability or major structural failure/damage. Off-site environmental discharge/release not contained and significant long-term environmental harm.	H (1) <i>(High)</i>	1	1	2
M (2) <i>(Medium level of harm)</i>	Potential temporary disability or minor structural failure/damage. On-site environmental discharge/release contained, minor remediation required, short-term environmental harm.	M (2) <i>(Medium)</i>	1	2	3
L (3) <i>(Low level of harm)</i>	Incident that has the potential to cause persons to require first aid. On-site environmental discharge/release immediately contained, minor level clean up with no short-term environmental harm.	L (3) <i>(Low)</i>	2	3	3
Level	Likelihood / Probability				
Likely	Could happen frequently				
Moderate	Could happen occasionally				
Unlikely	May occur only in exceptional circumstances				

HIERARCHY OF RISK CONTROL

The hierarchy of controls must be applied in the order below for all identified hazards.

Level 1 Eliminate the hazard
Level 2 Substitute the hazard with something safer.
Level 3 Isolate the hazard from people. Reduce the risks through engineering controls.
Level 4 Reduce exposure to the hazard using administrative actions.
Level 5 Use personal protective equipment
The control measures that you put in place should be reviewed regularly to make sure they work as planned

ACTIVITY ANALYSIS

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Training	To prevent injuries or illness to workers	1	1. Machinery operators will have the necessary current licence for the equipment they will operate. 2. All persons will have a current construction induction card.	Supervisor All	2
Arriving on site	Entry unsafe or unauthorised areas	1	1. Report to site office for site induction if required. 2. Risk assessment of site conditions and Site-specific induction & toolbox meeting to be conducted. 3. Consider all environmental protection issues and the impact caused by entry to site.	All Supervisor	2
Unloading Plant & equipment	Falls, slips & trips from vehicle, trucks and floats Machinery plant tipping over or falling from ramps	1	1. Ensure all vehicles are parked in a clear level area for unloading plant and equipment. 2. Extra care taken in wet conditions, use a ramp to load and unload plant. 3. Persons unloading equipment to wear seat belt. 4. Operators must be familiar with SWMS Loading & Unloading Plant & Equipment. 5. Only suitably trained personnel to work with plant	Operator	2
	Electrocution	1	1. Be aware of overhead power lines	Operator	2
	Traffic hazards, hit by vehicles or other on site plant and equipment	1	1. Ensure hazard & warning signage is in place as required when unloading plant. 2. Training in the use of PPE equipment such as fluorescent safety vests/clothing.	Operator Supervisor	2
General Safety rules for operation of an excavator.	Various including possible death if risk controls not followed.	1	1. Only competently trained and ticketed persons allowed to operate an excavator. 2. Operator to read and understand operator's manual prior to operating excavator as there are so many makes, types and models of excavators, and each type and model has been designed for a specific range of work under certain conditions. 3. Excavators are entirely dependent on gravity against overturning. The effects on loads, uneven, soft or sloping surfaces are critical, all having an important influence on the stability of the machine.	Management	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			- An excavator may also have practical limitations, such as tyre capacities, track widths and axle strengths. Excavators have been designed for a specific range of work and it is essential that the work performed is kept within the range. - The working load limit must be displayed on the machine if it is to be used for slinging loads or work other than earth moving. - Loads should only be attached to the machine on approved lugs or lifting devices not slung around the blade of the bucket. - A driver should not only demonstrate that he can safely drive an excavator. He is also required to have a satisfactory knowledge of the mechanical parts of the machine and be responsible for the making of regular inspections and the prompt reporting of unsafe conditions.		
Work area.	Striking persons of other items of plant	1	- Ensure all persons are aware of where excavator will be operating. - Restrict access and minimise plant working area as required. - All workers to wear safety vests or clothing. - Excavator to have operational flashing lights and travel alarms.	Supervisor All Operator	2
Pre-Start	Unsafe working conditions. Potential for accident.	1	- Pre-start briefing to ensure all staff are fully aware of the scope of work before work commences. - Ensure all workers have undertaken OH&S induction Operators, duties prior to operating an excavator are to: - Know the safe working load and under what conditions the excavator can be used. - Check for any loose bolts, pins, broken or badly worn gearing, sheaves and for any loose or missing keeper plates or pins. - Check the mechanical condition of the brakes, linings, bands for cracks and mechanical linkages. Ensure they are guarded against the entry of oil or water. - Ensure all guards and safety devices are replaced after adjustments, repairs or other work requiring the removal of protective equipment. - Ensure the excavator has been greased. Moving parts must be stopped before any greasing, adjusting or cleaning takes place.	Foreman Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			6. Check the mechanical condition of the operating controls. 7. Check the mechanical condition of the travelling brakes. 8. Check the mechanical condition of the limiting devices. 9. Check for any gear which has been haphazardly placed on the machine. 10. Check the internal combustion engine services. 11. Check the electric and hydraulic services. 12. Equipment Prestart checklist forms filled out & defects documented, supervisor notified. 13. Ensure windows/ mirrors are clean. 14. Ensure all controls are in neutral or park. 15. Ensure all gear in the cabin is correctly stored. 16. Adjust the seat and <u>use the seat belt whenever operating</u> . 17. Test hydraulic functions. 18. Ensure all grounded attachments are safely retracted 19. Test lights, horn and travel alarm. 20. Check safety locking pins in quick hitch are locked for buckets or attachments.		
Operation of excavator	Various including possible death if risk controls not followed.	1	On starting an excavator, the operator must: 1. Ensure all controls are in the neutral position before starting the motor. 2. Be in the correct driving position and seated correctly, so as to take control if the machine moves. Do not stand on tracks or near wheels. 3. Check that all persons are clear of the operating range of the bucket. 4. Ensure any gear placed in the driver's cabin is not fouling any controls. 5. Ensure that the bucket has been placed in a safe position. 6. Prior to digging, take into account the ground conditions. Never work close to loose banks or open trenches unless properly battered, benched or timbered, have a written geotechnical report provided by a qualified engineer. 7. When digging in virgin ground, break up the hard surface first before attempting large bites.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			8. Never undermine large rocks, trees or buildings and never dig too close under you own machine; 9. Watch out for underground services such as gas, water, telephone or electrical conduits. If in doubt as to their location, make BYDA enquires; 10. Keep any part of the excavator at least 4 metres clear of overhead powerlines of up to 132,000 volts and at least 7 metres clear of overhead powerlines which are above 132,000 volts. A warning notice is to be displayed in the cabin of the excavator. If excavator caught up on a powerline follow emergency procedures on A5 "Emergency Card". 11. DO not make jerky, sudden movements with any controls. This results in damage to the machine and inefficient work. 12. Always leave the bucket on the ground when not in use.		
Clearing & grubbing Excavation placement and compaction fill	Striking other objects whilst slewing excavator, materials on the ground flicking up as excavator travels over site. Overbalance of machine at reach.	1	1. Be aware of what obstacles are around the site especially when slewing excavator. 2. Assess what weights the machine can handle at reach safely before attempting to load trucks. 3. Do not carry passengers. 4. Keep machine under control at all times. 5. Carry the bucket as close to the ground as possible whilst traveling. 6. Travel & operate at a safe speed for the operation being undertaken.	Operator	2
	Attachments or bucket disconnecting from quick hitch.	1	1. Ensure quick hitch safety pins are engaged whilst bucket or attachments are engaged into quick hitch.	Operator	2
	Release of hydraulic hoses when changing work implements such as tilt bucket, pulverisor, rockbreaker and compaction plate.	1	1. Ensure hydraulic pressure is taken off hydraulic hoses before releasing couplings. Pressure is normally released if engine is shut down and work tool pedal is pressed back & forth or two way flow ball valve is switched off.	Operator	2
	Uncontrolled slippage	1	1. Assess ground surface conditions eg; wet ground conditions, steep slope.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
			2. When working on top of mound make sure excavator is not taken too close to the edge.		
	Rockbreaker & pulverizer operation Flying fragments or reo steel from concrete	1	1. Be aware that fragments can fly from chisel of the rockbreaker, and pulverizer. 2. Whilst operating excavator be aware that demolition debris such as reo. and pipe etc... can be flicked up by the tracks and could hit a worker or machine. 3. Use eye & hearing protection & keep others well away from work area. 4.	Operator	2
	Rock & log grab	2	1. Material or objects lifted can become insecure due to crumbling or breaking. Be aware of the different hydraulic pressures that can be applied to objects.	Operator	3
	Compaction plate	2	1. Be aware that vibration can affect nearby buildings or unstable ground or trench walls & excavations. 2. Assess the situation & surrounding areas that may be affected.	Operator	3
	Maintenance Potential for personal injury	1	1. During any periodic maintenance on the Excavator with Auger Attachment, it is required that the "Excavator" be positioned for maintenance and the engine of the machine then is stopped. 2. All controls must be tagged and locked (with the key removed) in the "rest position" and all pressure released from the system. 3. When changing auger and pilot bits, a soft-headed hammer must be used.	Operator Safety Observer/ Offsider	2
Lifting	Sling failure	1	1. The Working Load Limit (WLL) of the machine should be marked on the machine 2. Do not exceed the working load limit and work radius limits of the machine.	Operator	2
	Struck by moving load/part	1	1. Check the WLL of the machine and the lifting lugs, slings & chains to ensure the load is correctly slung and balanced and is within the WLL.	Operator	2

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
	Ground failure	1	1. If there is any sign of instability lower the load immediately.	Operator	2
	Failure during lifting	1	1. When the load is raised keep all people at a safe distance. 2. Do not swing loads over people's heads. 3. Do not leave the load suspended in the air. Lower it as soon as possible. 4. Always lower the load to the ground if leaving the machine. 5. Make allowances for materials when they are wet. They will weigh more than normal. 6. If you do not know the weight of the load, do not lift. 7. When working on sloping or flat surfaces be aware of the safe bucket capacity eg; rocks falling from an overfull bucket and damaging other items or persons. 8. Do not reeve or nip slings around buckets as the sling can be cut by the cutting edge or teeth of the bucket. 9. Do not place a sling over a tooth or teeth. 10. Place the lifting hook onto the approved lifting lug normally attached to the quick hitch. 11. The person who slings and directs the load must have a dogman/rigger certificate. (Or the lifting gear and load slinging method chosen by a rigger/dogman and not deviated from.) 12. Inspect all slings prior to use. Are they serviceable? 13. Refer to SWMS – Using Powered Earthmoving Equipment as a Crane.	Operator	2
Traveling equipment on roadway , private or public areas	Damage to roadway or public / private property	2	1. Check ownership of properties or boundaries. 2. Travel machine as to avoid disturbance to roadway or public or private lands eg; lift machine to turn on undisturbed areas if required, avoid sharp turns on roadways. 3. Be aware of what damage the tracks can do to surfaces.	Operator	3

Steps in Activity	Potential Hazards	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class After Controls In Place
Maintenance Refueling	Personal injury Fire/explosion	1	1. Do not leave the engine running while making adjustments or repairs unless specifically recommended and a maintenance person is assisting. 2. Never refuel when the engine is running. 3. Do not smoke while filling the fuel tank or servicing the fuel system. 4. Do not oil, grease, or adjust any part of the excavator while it is in motion. Check for faulty wiring or loose connections. 5. Never allow anyone to work under a raised bucket or other attachment.	Operator Maintenance person	2
Equipment shut down	Personnel struck by rolling plant	1	1. Assess parking area as to site vision for other works in the area, avoid parking where vision is blocked. 2. Park on firm, level ground where possible. 3. Park the machine 'up and down' the slope when parking on a grade. 4. Park in a non-operating area. 5. Park away from deep excavations and trenches. 6. Place the hydraulic lock mechanism in the lock position. 7. Lower the bucket or attachment to the ground. 8. Idle the engine for gradual cooling before turning it off. 9. Move the steering levers back and forward and cycle the hydraulic controls to dissipate residual pressure in the hydraulic system before leaving the machine. 10. Remove the ignition key and secure the machine.	Operator	2
Environmental Issues	Transmission of material off site to public domain eg mud or to main road.	2	1. Where possible endeavor to not park in muddy areas.	Operator	3
	Hydraulic oil spill	3	1. Make sure there is a visual check of all hydraulic hoses is part of your pre start check. 2. Should there be an extensive oil leak- clean it up immediately.	Operator	3

ENVIRONMENTAL RISK ASSESSMENT & CONTROL MEASURES THAT MAY BE REQUIRED ON SITE DEPENDING ON THE ACTIVITY					
Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Emergencies	Accident/ Incident Fire Spill	1	1. Personnel have been advised at toolbox meeting and are prepared in the event of an incident occurring. 2. Emergency numbers available on site. 3. Fire Extinguishers/First Aid Kits/Spill Kits are to be on site.	Supervisor All	2
Air Quality	Exhaust Fumes Dust	2	1. Control exhaust emissions eg regular maintenance, replace old machinery, fit appropriate emission control measures. 2. Dampen milled surface with water cart. 3. Use water cart where required.	Supervisor All	3
Community Relations	Inconvenience as a result of works/traffic management	2	1. Identify from the list of potentially impacted parties who may be impacted by the work being undertaken. 2. Letter drops could be considered (unless specifically required) to notify residents/businesses etc. about works to be undertaken and if it has an effect on them.	Supervisor All	3
Flora & Fauna	Some works may require the removal of vegetation. Native fauna may be at risk from excavation works	2	1. Assess work area for significant vegetation: size of trees, faunal habitat - define work and exclusion areas using fencing and signage. 2. Machinery is to be thoroughly washed down prior to leaving site where noxious weeds are present.	Supervisor All	3
Heritage & Archaeology	Unmonitored excavation at significant sites can lead to loss or destruction of valuable artifacts/relics, and disturbance of historical sites. including cultural heritage and/or archaeological significance	1	1. Undertake a survey of the site to identify any areas of significance. The client's representative may undertake this. Government bodies may be able to assist. 2. Develop a project specific procedure based on the findings and recommendations. 3. Installation of exclusion fencing and signage if required.	Supervisor All	2
Noise Pollution, Community Relations & Vibration	Sensitivity to noise - to public & fauna	1	1. Work undertaken during "normal" hours where possible. 2. Affected residents notified in person or in writing. 3. Plant and equipment regularly serviced & fitted with efficient mufflers. 4. Magnitude of vibration reduced by using smaller plant etc.	Supervisor All	2

Work Activity Risk	Hazard	Risk Class	Risk Control Measure	Responsible Person/s	Risk Class after Controls in place
Soil Management & Water Quality	Soil needs to be managed to ensure that; there are no off-site impacts. Damage to stockpile areas (not prepared properly). Mud deposited onto roadways.	2	1. Wash down machinery in only nominated areas. 2. Not within 20 metres of water courses. 3. Use only approved and nominated stockpile areas. 4. If working near gutters, use silt traps and clean debris regularly. 5. Build bund wall out of material available on site. 6. Drivers to check vehicle tyres/bodies for build up of mud when leaving stockpile sites and remove if necessary.	Supervisor All	3
Fuels and Chemicals	Contamination of waterways due to spillages of oil, degreasers, diesel, etc.	1	1. Store fuel and chemicals in accordance with relevant standards/guidelines. 2. Minimise storage on site and locate storage facilities away from drains and waterways. 3. All containers clearly labelled, and Safety Data Sheets are available on site. 4. All drums stored securely and in a bunded area. 5. Spill kits or alternative spill containment materials available on site. 6. Regular maintenance of plant hoses. 7. Use correct refueling equipment.	Supervisor All	2
Visual Impact Litter and Amenities Waste Management	Litter such as paper, plastic, and other refuse as well as being a possible safety risk may be carried off-site or washed into waterways resulting in pollution and danger to native fauna. Litter is also visually obtrusive. Production generated lighting, litter, mud, dirt and dust may also impact residents.	2	1. Use site induction to communicate the requirement for a tidy site. Also stress consideration for local residents. 2. If as a result of our works, dirt, mud, or litter affects a resident, then we will rectify this problem immediately. 3. Inspect the site frequently and insist on tidiness. Ensure public roads are free of dirt/mud from the work site. 4. Broken-out paved surfaces shall be repaired as soon as possible. 5. Remove all rubbish from site each day. 6. Waste products will be recycled where possible.	Supervisor All	3

Personal Protective Equipment						
All site personnel must wear the required PPE specified in the controls above, such as:						
Safety Hi-vis Vests/Shirts	Safety Boots	Sunscreen	Broad Brimmed Sun Hat	Sunglasses	Gloves specific to the task	White reflective overalls/night
Hard Hat where required	Safety Glasses	Hearing protection where required	Long clothing	Dust masks	Respiratory equipment if required	

Workers may require Task Specific Training depending on activity each worker will be required to fulfill.				
All workers shall hold a current Construction Induction Card				
- If required Client Site Induction - Activity Induction (SWMS & SWP's)	Vehicle Licences (Car or Truck depending on class of vehicle or mobile plant driven)	Plant Operators licences or competency assessments where required	Competencies for Work Zone Traffic Management	
First Aid certificate training	Manual Handling training	Fire Extinguisher training	Fatigue Management Training	

A Site Specific Induction & Toolbox Meeting will be held each day prior to the start of each job.			
--	--	--	--

Legislation & Codes of Practice (refer to company Legislation register for applicable Australian Standards applicable to works)			
Work Health & Safety Act 2012 and Work Health & Safety Regulations 2022			
Codes of Practice			
Confined Spaces - 2020	Hazardous Manual Tasks - 2020	Managing Noise & Preventing Hearing Loss at Work-2020	Managing Risks of Plant in the Workplace - 2018
Construction Work - 2020	How to Manage WH&S Risks - 2018	Managing Risk of Falls at Workplaces - 2020	Managing Electrical Risks in the Workplace -2019
Excavation Work - 2020	First Aid in the Workplace - 2018	Managing Work Environment & Facilities - 2020	WHS Consultation Co-operation & Co-ordination - 2018
Welding Processes - 2021	How to Safely Remove Asbestos - 2020	Managing Risk of Hazardous Chemicals - 2018	Safe Design of Structures - 2018

Plant & Equipment for this activity			
- All plant is inspected prior to sending out to site - Daily maintenance & service checks. - Daily pre-start checks are conducted on all plant and trucks by the operators and daily checklist filled out. - Regular servicing at 250hr intervals or as per manufactures specifications. Service History available on request to the office.			

List of plant for this Activity			

Engineering details/certificates/regulatory approvals/permits/electrical isolation (if applicable):			

Implementation, Monitoring and Review of SWMS

The Supervisor on site has the responsibility to:

- Brief each team member on this SWMS before commencing work.
- Ensure control measures have been implemented prior to the start of works.
- Observe work being carried out.
- If controls documented in SWMS are not adequate, stop the work, review the SWMS, adjust as required and re-brief the team.
- Ensure team knows that work is to immediately stop if the SWMS is not being followed.
- Retain this SWMS on site for the duration of the high-risk construction work.
- All persons involved in these particular tasks on site must sign this document as read and understood.

SWMS attendance sheet — I have been given the opportunity to provide input into the development and review of this SWMS

Name (please print clearly)	Signature	Company	Date

Daily pre-start meetings will be held to ensure all workers are informed of control measures and additional safety hazards & controls to be noted on toolbox form.